



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 516

LCO No. 3319



Referred to Committee on FINANCE, REVENUE AND BONDING

Introduced by:
(FIN)

AN ACT CONCERNING THE REDEMPTION RATE AND REFUND VALUE OF BEVERAGE CONTAINERS.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. (*Effective from passage*) (a) (1) To evaluate the effectiveness
2 of the antifraud and enforcement measures enacted pursuant to public
3 act 26-2, the Commissioner of Revenue Services shall, not later than
4 February 15, 2027, determine for calendar year 2026 the state-wide
5 average redemption rate of all beverage containers, as defined in section
6 22a-243 of the general statutes, and the redemption rate of beverage
7 containers for each deposit initiator. If the commissioner determines
8 that the state-wide redemption rate or the redemption rate of any
9 deposit initiator was more than one hundred per cent for calendar year
10 2026, notwithstanding the provisions of subdivision (1) of subsection (a)
11 of section 22a-244 of the general statutes, the refund value under said
12 subdivision shall be reduced to five cents, effective July 1, 2027, or as
13 soon as practicable thereafter for the beverage industry to implement
14 the change.

15 (2) The refund value shall remain at five cents until such time as the
 16 commissioner certifies, based on irrefutable evidence, that one hundred
 17 per cent of the beverage containers redeemed in this state are beverage
 18 containers originally sold in this state.

19 (b) Each deposit initiator that submitted a quarterly report pursuant
 20 to section 22a-245a of the general statutes that properly reported a
 21 negative balance in such deposit initiator's special account during the
 22 fiscal years ending June 30, 2025, and June 30, 2026, where such negative
 23 balance resulted from the overredemption of beverage containers and
 24 the payment of handling fees associated therewith, may apply to the
 25 Secretary of the Office of Policy and Management, in the form and
 26 manner prescribed by the secretary, for full reimbursement of the
 27 financial loss to the deposit initiator as a result of the overredemption of
 28 beverage containers.

29 (c) Nothing in this section shall affect the rate of the handling fee set
 30 forth in subsection (d) of section 22a-245 of the general statutes.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
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Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section
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Statement of Purpose:

To provide for the reduction of the beverage container refund value and for reimbursement to deposit initiators for certain losses resulting from overredemption if the Commissioner of Revenue Services determines that the redemption rate for beverage containers exceeds one hundred per cent for calendar year 2026.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]